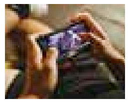
A hearty update
WhatsApp is working on a new update that will display its heart emojis in a larger font. **https://dgit.in/dec22-53**



ED investing gaming companies
Some gaming companies have been accused of cheating The Government of ₹20,000 Crore. **https://dgit.in/dec22-54**

CBDC vs Cryptocurrency, e-Rupee vs UPI

All your FAQs answered here

Kajoli Anand Puri | feedback@digit.in

With India's digital economy slated to grow to $800 billion by 2030, and over ₹8.2 trillion worth of UPI payments facilitated in the country as of February 2022, the digital payments sector is believed to be in its infancy as far as reaching its potential is concerned. The normalisation of UPI payments, coupled with a general openness towards cryptocurrency investments, apps that facilitate the same, and FinTech apps has perhaps been a critical factor in spurring the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to create the Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC). Now, after a month of rolling out the wholesale version of the e₹-W for banks, the RBI has finally announced the launch of the CBDC for consumers (e₹-R).

WHAT IS DIGITAL RUPEE?

Also referred to as an e-rupee, e₹-R, or digital rupee, the CBDC is essentially a digital form of the country's legal tender - the rupee. In simple terms, this means that it can be used to facilitate any transactions where one would normally use paper money. Explaining the concept, RBI said "CBDC is the legal tender issued by a central bank in a digital form. It is the same as a fiat currency and is exchangeable one-to-one with the fiat currency. Only its form is different." The CBDC will take the form of a digital token, and will be available in the same denominations as cash. While the tokens will be distributed by intermediary banks, customers will have to use a digital wallet in order to make transactions. Individuals will be able to transfer funds to each other, as well as to merchants, and the latter will be facilitated by simply scanning a QR code (the way one does to make a UPI payment). "The e₹-R would offer features of physical cash like trust, safety, and settlement finality. As in the case of cash, it will not earn any interest and can be converted to other forms of money, like deposits with banks," elaborated the RBI. The pilot project of the CBDC has been launched in Delhi, Bhubaneshwar, Mumbai, and Bangalore, with cities